

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P - Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-500-STEP Sanctions/Good Cause
	Document No./Name	P-520-STEP Failure to Comply
	Effective Date	February 15, 2024

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

The appropriate STEP sanction shall be applied for FITAP families that include work-eligible recipients (or work-eligible parents who are not included in the FITAP certification) when the work-eligible recipient or the excluded parent fails to comply with the requirements of the program.

NOTE: STEP sanctions are not applied to caretaker relatives or parents not included because he or she receives SSI or is an alien who is ineligible due to immigration status.

II. PROCEDURES

STEP sanctions are applied when work-eligible recipients or work-eligible parents:

- Fail without good cause to complete a Family Assessment.
- Fail without good cause to keep scheduled appointment to complete a Family Success Agreement.
- Fail without good cause to return a signed Family Success Agreement.
- Fail to attend school or other educational classes designed to obtain a high school diploma or GED, as specified in the Family Success Agreement, when the work-eligible recipient or excluded parent is a minor parent who has not received a high school diploma or GED.
- Fail to attend parenting skills education without good cause and other training conducive to the unique needs of new parents, as specified in the Family Success Agreement, when the work-eligible recipient or excluded parent is pregnant or has a child under age 1.
- *** * Fail to make progress towards achieving self-sufficiency goals ** without good cause, as specified in the Family Success Agreement. In these cases, the sanction cannot be cured by participating in the activity prior to expiration of the advance notice of adverse action because the notice period will end prior to the required two weeks of satisfactory participation.
- Decline or refuse the opportunity for employment, quits a job without good cause, or voluntarily reduces earnings.
- Fail without good cause to meet other requirements specified in the Family Success Agreement, including but not limited to:
 - Cooperation with Child Support Enforcement,
 - Meeting immunization requirements for children,
 - Compliance with drug screening and treatment requirements, or

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P - Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-500-STEP Sanctions/Good Cause
	Document No./Name	P-520-STEP Failure to Comply
	Effective Date	February 15, 2024

- Providing documentation of participation hours at timeframes based on each assigned work activity.

NOTE: If the client ends the failure to comply prior to the expiration of the advance notice of adverse action, the sanction should be removed and good cause does not have to be determined.

If a potential work-eligible recipient is currently sanctioned and applies for FITAP benefits and does not satisfactorily participate in the previously assigned activity or another approved STEP activity such as employment or education for a two-week period, the FITAP application is rejected. In these instances, a STEP sanction is not appropriate.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms or instructions associated with this policy.

IV. REFERENCES

[LAC 67:II Subpart 2. Family Independence Temporary Assistance Program \(FITAP\) Program, Chapter 12, Subchapter B – Conditions of Eligibility: 1231, 1239, 1241, and 1249](#)